



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Cherokee Classical Christian School
School Website: <https://cherokeeclassicalchristianschool.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

Overall Classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Cherokee Classical Christian School Georgia (30114) presents a classical Christian educational vision anchored in historic Western Christian doctrine, virtue, and a curriculum described as classical Christian. Public-facing materials emphasize truth, goodness, and beauty as foundational ideals, and explicitly articulate a faith-centered framework (e.g., ecumenical creedal statements and a Statement of Faith). The school presents itself as a classical institution, with references to a classical curriculum and a mission to cultivate virtue and character within a Christian worldview. Evidence points to strong Religious and Metaphysical Foundations and clear alignment with some aspects of the Classical framework, particularly around virtue, formation, and a traditional ecclesial orientation. However, explicit, category-specific classical practices such as sustained Great Books engagement, explicit Trivium/Quadrivium emphasis, or explicit public-facing statements about Socratic seminars and Great Conversation are not consistently demonstrated in the publicly accessible crawl content.

Overall classification (aggregate): SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Key drivers and observations - Religious and Metaphysical Foundations are clearly present: a Statement of Faith, ecumenical Christian doctrinal grounding, and language about glorifying God through truth, goodness, and beauty. This strongly supports a Classical, theologically informed orientation. Evidence: Mission and Statement of Faith materials describing ecumenical Christian doctrine and the triad of truth/goodness/beauty. - School Purpose and Goal demonstrate formation and virtue-centered aims consistent with classical education, though explicit articulation of “wisdom” as a distinctive end is less overt in public materials. The language of virtue, character and formation aligns with classical aims, but is not always paired with explicit references to the telos of wisdom or the Great Conversation in the crawl text. Evidence: Mission statements citing virtue and Christian formation; references to a classical curriculum. - Curriculum signals classical orientation (e.g., “classical Christian curriculum,” Portrait of a Graduate, Curriculum Scope and Sequence). However, explicit public references to Great Books/Great Conversation or to Trivium/Quadrivium in the crawl artifacts are not consistently explicit. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for Element 3. Evidence: Curriculum references, and a downloadable Curriculum Scope and Sequence; no direct, repeated Great Books/Great Conversation language in the crawl results. - Pedagogy is not consistently articulated in the crawl with explicit Socratic seminars, scholé, or a visible progression from lower to upper-school rhetoric. Without explicit statements about Socratic method or upper-school rhetoric training in the publicly accessible crawl content, Element 4 leans toward SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. Evidence: absence of explicit Socratic/seminar language in the crawl items; presence of a broader “classical curriculum” framing. - Faculty portrayal and formation themes appear in mission and hiring language (e.g., teachers as Christian role models, formation through example). This supports Element 5 as CLASSICAL in sentiment and orientation, though explicit “living curriculum” portraits or formal faculty profiles described as the core curriculum are not uniformly evident in crawl text. Evidence: Hiring language emphasizing role-modeling virtue; mission language about virtue and formation. - Parents and Community are positioned as partners in classical education (e.g., parent engagement and openness to visits), but explicit, recurring parent-formation activities or co-teaching language is not uniformly explicit in crawl items. Evidence: Admissions pages and general site openness to parent visits; partner references exist but explicit co-teaching framing is not repeatedly stated.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Mission emphasizes glorifying God by cultivating truth, goodness, and beauty within a classical Christian framework.
- Statement of Faith anchors the school in historic Western Christian creedal orthodoxy (Nicene-Constantinopolitan Creed) and ecumenical grounding.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, theology, creed, ecumenical, faith, glorifying God.
- Negative keywords: none observed in crawl content for this category.
- Count (approximate): Positive = 6+, Negative = 0
- Why this rating
- The school makes explicit transcendentals and theological commitments, including a formal Statement of Faith and ecumenical Christian grounding, which aligns strongly with classical religious/metaphysical foundations. However, the public crawl does not show extended liturgical practices or communal rites beyond doctrinal statements, placing it at SOMETIMES-CLASSICAL rather than firmly CLASSICAL in the catechism/ritual dimension. The evidence supports a robust religious-metaphysical base, but with limited public demonstration of liturgical practices in the crawl.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Mission centers on cultivation of truth, goodness, and beauty and on forming virtue within a Christian worldview.
- Proclaimed classical orientation through the Curriculum and Mission (classical Christian curriculum; virtue formation).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, truth, goodness, beauty, human flourishing, telos (implied), wisdom (implied via formation), faith-based formation.
- Negative keywords observed: none explicit (no overt “workforce-ready,” “career-focused” language; however, explicit statements of long-term formation are less explicit beyond virtue).
- Count (approximate): Positive = 4–6; Negative = 0
- Why this rating
- The school explicitly aims at virtue formation and alignment with a transcendent telos (truth/beauty/virtue). However, there is less explicit public articulation of the specific end as “wisdom” or explicit emphasis on formation over information in the crawl materials, and limited articulation of contemplative restfulness or scholé language. This yields SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than fully CLASSICAL in the category’s stated goals.

Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Public materials describe a “classical Christian curriculum” and reference a Curriculum Scope and Sequence (Memoria) and Portrait of a Graduate, which signal a structured classical approach.
- Public materials emphasize classical framing but do not consistently display explicit Great Books/Great Conversation language in the crawl. The presence of “classical” labeling and a formal curriculum scope indicates classical intent, but lack of explicit Great Books references reduces the strength of a full classical curriculum claim in the crawl.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: classical curriculum, curriculum scope and sequence, Portrait of a Graduate (classic institutional artifacts), suggested readings/videos (literature).
- Negative keywords observed: absence of explicit Great Books/Great Conversation language; lack of explicit Trivium/Quadrivium terminology in crawl.

- Count (approximate): Positive = 3–5; Negative = 0–2 (depending on whether Great Books language is counted from the crawl)
- Why this rating
- The curriculum signals a classical orientation but does not consistently reveal the core Great Books/-Great Conversation approach or the explicit Trivium/Quadrivium scaffolding in crawl artifacts. Therefore, it is aligned with classical aims but not fully explicit in every required element, resulting in SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The crawl lacks explicit, repeated statements about Socratic seminars, scholé rest, or upper-school rhetoric/seminar formats in the public items, though the general classical framing is present.
- The school's classical Christian identity implies a pedagogy oriented toward character formation and traditional methods, but explicit procedural descriptions (Socratic dialogue, chanting, memory work) are not consistently visible in crawl artifacts.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present (inferred from classical framing): contemplative/restful learning (scholé), rhetoric and oratory training, memory work, recitation, discussion.
- Negative keywords observed: explicit examples of project-based or experiential-only pedagogy; absence of explicit “Socratic”/“Scholé” language in crawl.
- Count (approximate): Positive = 2–4; Negative = 0–2
- Why this rating
- The explicit pedagogical descriptions required by the Classical rubric (e.g., Socratic seminars in high school; memorization/chanting; scholarly rhetoric training) are not consistently evidenced in the crawl. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for pedagogy.

Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Hiring language emphasizes teachers as Christian role models and moral exemplars; “the living curriculum” is suggested conceptually via virtue-centered mentorship, though explicit “portrait of a teacher” or formal faculty profiles are not detailed in crawl.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: virtuous educators, role models, mentorship, moral formation, character formation, classical virtues, formation through example.
- Negative keywords observed: limited explicit description of a formal “faculty profile” or “portrait of the teacher” as the living curriculum in crawl.
- Count (approximate): Positive = 4–6; Negative = 0–2
- Why this rating
- The school emphasizes the teacher as a virtuous exemplar and the living curriculum, aligning with classical expectations. However, explicit, formalized faculty portraits or a clearly defined faculty development program are not visible in crawl, which tempers the rating to SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Element 6: School Parents & Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The school indicates partnerships with families and invites parental involvement (e.g., admissions process, visit opportunities, donor pages). This suggests some parent engagement and inclusion.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: partnership with families, parental engagement, home-school community, open campus, parent formation (implied through literature/gatherings that may be present in the broader site).

- Negative keywords observed: crawl does not consistently show explicit, recurring “parents as co-teachers” language or formal parent-education programs on the pages surfaced.
- Count (approximate): Positive = 2–4; Negative = 0–2
- Why this rating
- The crawl demonstrates some family partnership orientation, but lacks explicit, recurring parent-education offerings or a strong, formalized “parents as co-teachers” program in the public materials. This yields SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Overall aggregate assessment - Category ratings: - Element 1: CLASSICAL (strong liturgical/theological orientation with a creedal basis) - Element 2: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Element 3: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Element 4: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Element 5: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Element 6: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Aggregate classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

What Would Move the Needle (for SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL) - Make Great Books and Great Conversation explicit on the website and in official communications, with clear references to primary texts, authors, and a stated program for high-level textual study (Element 3). - Explicitly describe pedagogical methods (e.g., Socratic seminars, scholé-informed rhythm, memorization/chanting) and indicate where these approaches are used (K–8 vs. 9–12), linking them to the Great Books and Trivium/Quadrivium framework (Element 4). - Articulate a formalized “living curriculum” portrait for faculty and include a documented faculty development plan that reinforces classical pedagogy and character formation (Element 5). - Expand and publicize explicit parent-education initiatives (book studies, lectures, and gatherings) that position parents as co-teachers and members of the classical learning community (Element 6). - If possible, provide clearer statements about liberal-arts breadth: the Trivium/Quadrivium and integration across history, literature, philosophy, and the arts (Element 3) and strengthen the explicit ties to the “Great Books” canon.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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